

Methodology

The Delphi Approach

This report's findings are based on a three-round Delphi study conducted to evaluate and achieve expert consensus on the future state of people analytics. The Delphi method is an iterative research framework that allows a panel of subject matter experts to collaboratively refine their perspectives over multiple survey rounds. Responses are summarized after each round to identify shared themes allowing the panel to progressively move toward a consensus view on industry priorities and challenges. Because this Delphi study targeted highly experienced, senior practitioners rather than entry-level personnel, the data represents a high-level qualitative alignment of industry leaders rather than a broad statistical survey.

Expert Panel Composition

The study relied on the professional judgment, observations, and informed viewpoints of a specialized expert panel comprising 18 distinct contributors. The panel captured diverse voices across the HR and analytics spectrum, ensuring a balanced evaluation of both technical and operational applications.

The participant pool included strategic leaders (CEOs, Founders, Managing Partners, and VPs of People Analytics) as well as hands-on practitioners (Senior Data Analytics Strategists, Directors of Data Engineering, and Workforce Planning Consultants). Experts represented a wide range of organizations, spanning large enterprise brands to specialized consulting and HR technology firms.

While the total pool consisted of 18 experts, participation varied slightly across the iterative phases as the consensus narrowed: 16 experts contributed to Round 1, 12 experts completed Round 2, and 14 experts finalized the consensus in Round 3.

Advisory Board Insights

In addition to the Delphi survey rounds, the analysis was heavily informed by qualitative discussions with a dedicated Advisory Board. During the advisory board discussion, industry leaders provided critical context to the survey data, deepening the report's insights on organizational behavior, business alignment, and technological adoption.

Study Execution

Round 1: Exploratory Discovery

The initial round utilized open-ended questions to gather broad qualitative insights from the expert panel. Participants shared their professional experiences and observations to identify emerging trends and foundational challenges within the field.

Round 2: Evaluation and Prioritization

Qualitative insights from the first round were synthesized into distinct thematic categories. During this phase, the panel evaluated, prioritized, and refined these topics. Experts weighed the relative importance of various strategies and identified the most critical areas for future focus.

Round 3: Strategy and Execution

In the final phase, the panel was asked to make definitive choices to resolve closely matched priorities from the preceding survey. Experts selected single top priorities and recommended the most effective approaches to finalize group consensus.

